

whatweretheythinking.com

www.belch.com

You wouldn't believe it, but this site is exactly what the name says—a collection of belches. Don't get it? OK, we will spell it out for you. The site contains a whole bunch—and we mean a whole bunch—of downloadable audio files containing recorded belches submitted by different people.

To be honest, the titles given to all belches are hilarious. Consider, "Who says French Canadians can't do anything right?" or "Here is Michelle and her 'popcorn' belch", "This long grumbling belch is courtesy of 'Zode'", "Trisha is sweet sixteen, and she has an equally sweet burp", and so on. Do you really want to download those belches and listen to them? In fact, has anyone ever downloaded those belches and listened to them?

There are extras such as celebrity belches, a guide to 'Things that make you go *Buurrp*', a brief section called 'What is a belch', and so on. Titles such as "Sangria, a girl, pushes out this 36 second belch" may perhaps tempt the weirdo in you to actually listen—but nah, a burp is too gross to actually go all the way.

As with our previous selections in this space, someone who actually spends more than a minute on this site needs psychiatric help. To its credit, the site does make fun of itself—it says it's the 'dumbest site on the Net'. We'll concede this much: the site makes for a funny two-minute read—but no belches, please!



larger particles "is how nanotechnology can take something that is extremely insoluble in nature, like some drugs, and by breaking them up to the nano-level help release them in the body," said Roger Aston, strategy director of pSivida in Perth, Australia.

In terms of enhancing the nutritional quality of food, "You can imagine there are some things that you would want to deliver to, say, the intestine and not the mouth," Dinsmore said. "For administering drugs to a patient, you can imagine delivering a medicine to the part of the body where it's needed most and not have to go everywhere else, so the overall dose you use is lower but the drug is used more effectively."

Aside from carrying drugs with precision, nanoparticles have the capability to break open upon command, something that could lead to smart, programmable foods and drinks.

Another concept under development involves nanoparticles that can stick to specific parts of the intestine. To enhance the absorption of medicines, researchers are creating nanoparticles that can hook onto the gut and thus stay longer, increasing drug uptake.

The future of edible nanotechnology could be silicon, Aston suggested. Unlike nanoparticles made of polymers, he noted, silicon does not need exotic chemical bonds to hold each nanoparticle's contents in place, bonds that conceivably could alter the content's properties. Aston explained, "The edible silicon made by pSivida has the capability of holding processors, so you could program chips in foodstuffs like you would computers or air conditioners." ■

Compiled by Aditya Kuber,
Meera Vankipuram,
Ram Mohan Rao and
Renuka Rane

Blog WATCH

From the fascinating world of blogs this month: what a really smart home should be, according to 'Mavromatic'; Carl Salminen's demand for baseball players in games to have the option of using steroids; yet another university computer system that got hacked into; and something about being alerted about elephants via SMS.

Carl Salminen
<http://snipurl.com/digitblog1>

Dope My Games

With all the hullabaloo surrounding steroid use by Major League Baseball players I think it's time that Electronic Arts pick up on the trend. After all, the motto for EA Sports is something like "If it's in the game, it's in the game". With that in mind, I demand that next year's baseball game include an option to inject steroids in my players and mutate them into Hulk-like monsters who knock out 100 home runs every year.

Mavromatic
<http://snipurl.com/digitblog2>

Two Years, Plus Two More

So I'm almost done with the construction of my new home, it has been two years of actual construction and two years of planning. High on my list was to design and install a complete home automation system in the house. My goal is really simple. There is no need to automate a toaster or have a TV screen built into my refrigerator. I believe a 'smart home' should be just that. Smart. It should be bright enough to know when I'm in proximity. Lets say I pull into my driveway and open the garage door at 10 pm. The house should turn on the lights leading to my bedroom at 45 per cent brightness. If I turn lights on after midnight, to get a drink of water or go to the bathroom, the switches should know to only turn the

lights on 25 per cent, as I don't want to be fully awakened. A video server will play a major part...

Heath Dixon
<http://snipurl.com/digitblog3>

Speaking Of Which, Another University Gets Hacked

California State University, Chico, announced that it has informed more than 59,000 people that their personal information may have been compromised in an attack on the school's servers earlier this week.

The school reports that computer hackers gained access to a University Housing and Food Service system. The system contained personal information—including names and Social Security numbers—of people with different ties to the university.

Roland Piquetpaille
<http://snipurl.com/digitblog4>

Elephants Send SMS to Tell Where They Are

Two months ago, I told you that the Wildlife Conservation Society was planning to count elephants from space. So I was very intrigued by a very short article from the Inquirer, "Elephants text their location."

This teasing story said that when elephants start to approach their fields, the farmers are alerted by SMS in time to politely ask the elephants to move over and save their crops. The whole story is told on the Save the Elephants (STE) site.